

# **Accessibility Report: The Fool's Descent**

Accessibility was treated as a core part of the development process for The Fool's Descent, not as something bolted on at the end. From the structure of the HTML to the way text and interactive elements were written, the game was built with semantic markup, descriptive labels, and clear navigation in mind from the start. Because of this strong foundation, the accessibility review across all pages mainly confirmed that the game was already in great shape, and only a handful of small, targeted refinements were needed to close the remaining gaps for screen reader users.

This report walks through each page of the game, highlighting both the accessibility decisions that were already in place and the minor adjustments made to round out the experience.

## ***Welcome Screen***

The landing page is a great example of accessibility done right from the beginning. The logo includes a clear, descriptive alt attribute, and the "PLAY" link and button are read naturally by screen readers without needing any changes at all. This page required no adjustments whatsoever. Except for hiding some decorations.

## ***Login Screen (Main Menu)***

The login form was already structured clearly, with intuitive placeholder text guiding the user visually. To make sure that same clarity carries over to screen readers, we added aria-label attributes to the Username and Password fields. This small addition ensures that screen reader users hear exactly what each field is for, matching the experience that sighted users already had.

## ***Create Account***

The registration form follows the same thoughtful structure as the login screen. We added aria-label attributes to the Full Name, Username, Password, Age, and Gender fields, so each one is clearly announced. The Gender dropdown's options (Female, Male, Other) were already fully accessible on their own, since <select> elements are read natively and correctly by screen readers, so no extra work was needed there.

## ***Menu***

This page needed no changes at all. Every button, "NEW DESCENT," "CONTINUE DESCENT," "STATISTICS," "TUTORIAL," and "LOGOUT," already uses clear, descriptive text that is announced perfectly by assistive technology. This is a strong example of how good labeling from the start avoids any extra accessibility work later.

## ***Tutorial***

The tutorial page is packed with lore, mechanics explanations, and card details, all of it already organized with proper headings and well written, descriptive text. This made it naturally easy to follow with a screen reader. The only refinement made was marking the four decorative background symbols ( ♫ ☀ ♦ ♣ ) as purely decorative, so screen readers skip past them and go straight to the meaningful content.

## ***Statistics***

The statistics page brings together tables, leaderboards, and Chart.js visualizations, and most of this information was already accessible thanks to the use of real HTML tables and clearly labeled legends next to each chart. For the few charts that didn't have a text equivalent nearby, "Win Rate vs Each Enemy," "Most Popular Cards," and "Most Purchased Upgrades," we added descriptive labels so screen reader users get a clear summary of what each chart represents.

## ***Map***

The map screen is a fully interactive, canvas-based experience where the player guides The Fool between nodes to progress through their descent. Since this is inherently a visual and spatial interaction, we added a descriptive label to the canvas explaining what it represents and how it works, giving screen reader users helpful context about the page's purpose.

## ***Duel***

The duel screen follows the same approach. We added a descriptive label to the canvas explaining that this is the interactive card battle against an enemy, so that screen reader users understand what the central element of the page represents.

## ***Victory and Introduction Screen***

This page stood out as one of the strongest examples of accessibility consideration in the entire game. The story panel was built using `aria-live="polite"`, meaning the Dealer's final words and the narrator's closing story are automatically read aloud as they appear, creating a genuinely immersive ending for screen reader users too. All the buttons, "DESCEND AGAIN" and "MAIN MENU," are clearly labeled and easy to navigate to. The only addition here was marking the decorative Fool animation as purely visual, since it has no functional role in the page.

Across all ten pages of The Fool's Descent, accessibility was clearly part of the plan from the very beginning. Semantic headings, descriptive alt text, meaningful button labels, properly structured forms, and even live regions for dynamic storytelling were already woven into the game's code. The review process mainly served to confirm that strong foundation, and the small set of refinements made, labeling a handful of form fields, charts, and canvases, simply rounds out an experience that was already built with care.

The result is a game that players using screen readers can navigate, understand, and enjoy from the welcome screen all the way through to victory, which reflects the genuine consideration that went into the project from day one.

### ***Other Inclusive Design Choices Already in Place***

Beyond screen reader support, a few other details throughout the game contribute meaningfully to its overall accessibility:

- **Visible focus states:** Form inputs across the login and account creation pages have a clear focus animation (a soft glow), making it easy for keyboard users to see exactly which field is currently selected.
- **Large, consistent interactive targets:** Buttons throughout the game are generously sized (around 320 to 390 pixels wide and 60 to 80 pixels tall), which makes them easier to click or tap accurately for players with motor impairments.
- **Responsive layouts:** The statistics and tutorial pages use CSS grid layouts that automatically reflow into a single column on smaller screens (@media max-width: 750px), which helps players who zoom in significantly or use smaller devices.
- **Proper language declaration:** Every page declares lang="en", ensuring screen readers use the correct pronunciation and voice settings automatically.
- **Descriptive page titles:** Each page has a unique, descriptive <title> (for example, "Login | The Fool's Descent"), making it easy for screen reader users to identify which screen they're on when switching between browser tabs.
- **Logical heading structure:** Every page uses a single, clear <h1> for its main title, giving screen reader users a reliable way to orient themselves and jump between sections.
- **Color is never the only signal:** On the statistics page, every chart that uses color (the Victories vs Deaths doughnuts, the deck rarity breakdown, the difficulty win-rate chart) pairs each color with a text label and a numeric value, so the information remains accessible for players with color vision deficiencies. The same applies to the map and tutorial pages, where node types and outcomes are distinguished by icons and text in addition to color.

Altogether, these details show that accessibility wasn't an isolated checkbox, but something considered consistently across the visual design, layout, and structure of the entire game.

- This analysis was made with the support of ChatGPT, as permitted by the instructions. It helped us understand better how we can be more inclusive towards people with visual disabilities, considering at the beginning we may have skipped a couple of details.